

What probably happened?

Deducao muda de forma dependendo do momento: agora (must be) ou no passado (must have been). Hoje praticamos as duas com situacoes de viagem, hoteis e aeroportos.

TEXTO ADAPTADO NIVEL B1+

ganbare - you've got this

01 The Missing Suitcase

Leitura - By Yuki Tanaka

The bags stopped coming twenty minutes ago, and mine never appeared. A woman next to me shrugged¹. "It **must be** stuck on the flight from Seoul," she said. She sounded very calm², like someone who has seen this before. It wasn't really a guess³. It felt more like a conclusion⁴.

An airport worker walked past with a tablet. She didn't stop, so I asked her directly⁵. "It **could be** on the next flight," she said. "Or it **might be** sitting in Seoul until tomorrow. Hard to say." Two possibilities⁶. Both still open.

I thought back to check-in in Sao Paulo. The agent took a long time with my tag. I **must have missed** the connection⁷ by just a few minutes. Or maybe not. The tag **could have fallen off** somewhere between gates. I **can't have imagined** the whole thing. The tracking number was real, right there on my phone.

What struck me⁸, waiting under the airport lights, was how naturally we use these expressions when we don't know the truth. We don't say "I don't know." We say "it must be," "it could have been," "it can't have." We build a small, temporary certainty out of clues⁹. When my suitcase finally came out an hour later, it hadn't been in Seoul at all. It **must have been loaded** late in Sao Paulo. The ground team simply ran out of time¹⁰.

NOTAS DE LEITURA - GLOSSARIO

1. **shrugged**: moved the shoulders up to show you don't know or don't mind (*deu de ombros*; 肩をすくめた)
2. **calm**: relaxed, not worried or nervous (*calmo*; 落ち着いた)
3. **guess**: something you say without being sure it's true (*chute, suposicao*; 推測)
4. **conclusion**: the final decision you reach after thinking (*conclusao*; 結論)
5. **directly**: straight, without waiting or going through someone else (*diretamente*; 直接に)
6. **possibility**: something that could happen, but isn't certain (*possibilidade*; 可能性)
7. **connection**: a second flight that continues your trip (*conexao (voo)*; 乗り継ぎ)
8. **something struck me**: it suddenly made me think about it (*me chamou a atencao*; 心に浮かんだ)
9. **clues**: small pieces of evidence that help you understand something (*pistas*; 手がかり)
10. **to run out of time**: to have no more time left (*ficar sem tempo*; 時間切れになる)

02 Deduction - Present

Quick reference

~95%

must be

Evidencia forte, conclusao quase certa.

"He must be tired."

~50%

might/could be

Possibilidade real, sem certeza.

"That could be him."

~50%

may be

Igual a might be, mais formal.

"It may be closed."

~95%

can't be

Impossivel dado o contexto.

"That can't be right."

Regra de ouro: nunca "mustn't be" para deducao negativa. Impossibilidade no presente e sempre **can't be**.

02.1 Practice - Present Deduction

02.01

The suitcase on the belt has a name tag with someone else's name on it, clearly visible.

This _____ my suitcase.

A) must be B) might be C) can't be

02.02

Two lights are on in the ryokan, and you can faintly hear water running behind one of the doors.

Someone _____ taking a bath right now.

- A) might be B) must be C) can't be

02.03

You see a number you don't know calling. It could be the hotel, or it could be something else.

It _____ the hotel calling to confirm.

- A) must be B) can't be C) might be

02.04

Every clock in the train station shows the same time, matching your phone exactly.

The station clock _____ accurate.

- A) can't be B) must be C) might be

02.05

The receptionist checked your name twice and found nothing, but the system had a technical problem this morning.

The reservation _____ under a different name by mistake.

- A) must be B) could be C) can't be

02.06

The tour guide is wearing a thick winter coat, gloves, and a scarf outside with you.

She _____ freezing.

- A) can't be B) might be C) must be

03 Deduction - Past

Quick reference

~95%

must have been

Conclusao quase certa sobre o passado.

"She must have left."

~50%

might/could have been

Explicacao possivel para algo ja ocorrido.

"He could have missed it."

~50%

may have been

Igual a might have, mais formal.

"It may have been cancelled."

~95%

can't have been

Impossivel dado o que voce sabe.

"That can't have been him."

DICA

Formacao: modal + **have** + participio passado. O verbo depois de "have" nunca muda por pessoa.

REAL TALK

must be = agora. **must have been** = ja aconteceu. So adicionar **have + participio** muda para o passado.

03.1 Practice - Past Deduction

03.01

You wake up and find your window wide open, curtains soaked, and puddles on the floor.

It _____ heavily during the night.

- A) might have rained B) must have rained C) can't have rained

03.02

The guide said the shrine closes at 4pm all month, but these photos, dated last week, show it lit and open at 9pm.

Those photos _____ taken at the shrine, at least not this month.

- A) must have been B) can't have been C) might have been

03.03

Your friend didn't answer messages for six hours during her flight. Easily explainable.

She _____ her phone off during the flight.

- A) must have turned B) can't have turned C) might have turned

03.04

The receipt on the table shows two coffees and two pastries, though you were alone all morning.

Someone _____ you at the cafe. This receipt is for two people.

- A) might have joined B) can't have joined C) must have joined

03.05

Your flight landed at 11pm and the hotel is 40 minutes away, yet a text says you checked in at 11:05pm.

That message _____ sent at the right time. The times don't match.

- A) could have been B) must have been C) can't have been

03.06

Your umbrella is missing, but three nearly identical ones are still in the stand.

Someone _____ it by mistake. They do look alike.

- A) must have taken B) can't have taken C) could have taken

04 Mixed Practice

Presente ou passado?

04.01

Right now, every seat at the gate is empty and the screen shows nothing about this flight anymore.

They _____ already boarded everyone.

- A) must be B) can't be C) must have

04.02

Right now, you can hear two voices speaking Japanese quietly through the thin wall next door.

The couple next door _____ awake still.

- A) must have been B) can't have been C) must be

04.03

Looking back at last night, the streets were completely silent by 9pm, unusual for that neighbourhood.

There _____ some kind of local event keeping everyone indoors.

- A) must be B) must have been C) can't be

04.04

You're looking at the departures board right now and this gate number doesn't exist on the whole board.

This _____ the correct gate number.

- A) must be B) can't have been C) can't be

05 Asking & Answering

Formando perguntas e respostas curtas

Yes/No

"Could this be a mistake?"

Modal no inicio da frase.

Yes/No past

"Might they have missed the train?"

Modal + subject + have + participio.

Wh-question

"What could be causing the delay?"

Wh-word antes do modal.

Wh past

"Why might the flight have been cancelled?"

Wh-word + modal + subject + have + participio.

Short answer

"It could be, yes." / "Probably not, it can't be." / "It must have been, I think."

Resposta curta, sem repetir a frase toda.

EXEMPLO RESOLVIDO

Your hotel room smells strongly of smoke, even though you booked a non-smoking room.

Q: "What could have happened in this room?"

A: "Someone must have smoked here. The smell is too strong to be anything else."

Por que funciona: a pergunta usa "could have" porque voce ainda nao sabe a causa, so quer investigar. A resposta usa "must have" porque agora voce esta dando sua conclusao mais provavel, com confianca.

Situacao 1: A friend's phone has been off all day, with no reply to any message.

Write a yes/no question using "might have":

Write a short answer using "must have":

Situacao 2: The restaurant you booked is dark and empty when you arrive, though the sign says "Open."

Write a wh-question using "could be" (present):

Write a short answer using "can't be":

Situacao 3: Your suitcase arrived with a small new scratch on the side.

Write a wh-question using "might have happened" (past):

Write a short answer using "must have":

Situacao 4: Every shop on the street is closed at 3pm on a Tuesday, which feels unusual.

Write a yes/no question using "must be" (present):

Write a short answer using "could be":

06 Speaking Corner

DISCUSSION

- Think of a time something confusing happened while traveling: a missing bag, a wrong room, a delayed train. What did you think must have happened, in the moment?
- Look around this room right now. What's one thing you could make a deduction about? Try "that must be..." or "that can't be...".
- Have you ever been completely wrong about a deduction? What turned out to be the real explanation?
- A colleague didn't answer any messages all weekend. Give three possible explanations, using must have, might have, and could have.

Answer Key - Gabarito

Present Deduction

- 02.01: can't be
02.02: must be
02.03: might be
02.04: must be
02.05: could be
02.06: must be

Past Deduction

- 03.01: must have rained
03.02: can't have been
03.03: might have turned
03.04: must have joined
03.05: can't have been
03.06: could have taken

Mixed Practice

- 04.01: must have
04.02: must be
04.03: must have been
04.04: can't be

Asking & Answering · exemplos sugeridos

Situacao 1

- Q: Might her phone have died?
A: It must have. She never leaves it off this long.

Situacao 2

- Q: What could be going on here?
A: It can't be open. Everything is dark and locked.

Situacao 3

- Q: What might have happened to it during the flight?
A: It must have happened during loading. It wasn't there before.

Situacao 4

- Q: Must there be some kind of holiday today?
A: There could be. I'm not sure, but it would explain it.

Producao aberta. Estas sao sugestoes, nao as unicas respostas corretas. O professor confere junto com o aluno em aula.